Application Settings – Functional Workflow

Project: TaskFlow – Intelligent Task Allocation & Tracking System
Parent Module: Settings · **Child Module:** 08.1 Application Settings
Version: 1.0 · **Last Updated:** 31-Oct-2026
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1. Overview

Application Settings is the screen where an authorized user maintains the basic application-wide configuration: the brand name shown in the sidebar and header, the single application timezone, the default task priority, and whether in-app (bell) notifications are created at all. It corresponds to BRD Screen 20 "System Settings".

2. Purpose / Business Value

- The brand name, timezone and default priority are changed from the screen, not in code (BRD Screen 20 FR-1).
- The whole application uses one timezone to decide which calendar day a deadline falls on, so "due today" and "overdue" mean the same thing for everyone (BRD business rule 17).
- In-app notifications can be switched off for the whole organization with one toggle.
- The settings that every user can read (brand name, default priority) contain nothing secret (BRD Screen 20 FR-5).

3. Who Can Access

Role	Can See Screen	Can Use Screen	Access Level (Own / Team / Organization)
Administrator	✅	✅	Organization
Manager	❌	❌	– (reads the values behind the scenes only)
Employee	❌	❌	– (reads the values behind the scenes only)
Custom Role	Configurable	Configurable	Organization, when `settings.application.manage` is granted

> Note: Any signed-in user can **read** the application settings (the brand name in the header and the default priority on Create Task), but only holders of `settings.application.manage` can open the screen and change them.

4. Screens

#	Screen Name	Menu Path	Purpose	Visible To
1	Application Settings	Settings → Application Settings	Brand name, default timezone, default task priority, in-app notifications on/off	Administrator; custom roles with `settings.application.manage`

5. Screen & Functionality Details

5.1 Screen: Application Settings

Purpose: Maintain basic application-wide configuration (BRD Screen 20 "System Settings"). **Who can see this screen:** Administrator (and custom roles granted the permission). **Required permission:** `settings.application.manage`

Screen Elements

- Page title **Application settings** with the line "Application-wide configuration: the brand name, timezone, default task priority and in-app notifications."
- **General** group:
  - **Application name** (required). Hint: "Shown in the sidebar and header."
  - **Default timezone** (required). A text box with suggestions (UTC, Asia/Kolkata, Asia/Dubai, Europe/London, Europe/Berlin, America/New_York, America/Chicago, America/Los_Angeles, Australia/Sydney). Any valid timezone id can be typed. Hint: "Decides which calendar day a deadline belongs to. Applied immediately, no restart needed."
  - **Default task priority**: Low, Medium, High or Critical. Hint: "Pre-selected on the Create Task form."
- **Notifications** group: **Enable in-app notifications** toggle. Hint: "When off, no new bell notifications are created for any event. Existing notifications are kept."
- **Reminder defaults** group: a link to the **Reminder Settings** screen, where reminder intervals and Mail delivery are kept.
- **Save settings** button (shows "Saving..." while saving) and a **Saved** tick after a successful save.
- A loading placeholder, and an error card with a **Retry** button if the settings cannot be loaded.

5.2 Functionalities

#	Functionality	Purpose	Who Can See	Who Can Use	Permission Required	Scope
1	View application settings (screen)	Show the current values on the screen	Administrator	Administrator	`settings.application.manage`	Org
2	Read application settings (behind the scenes)	Brand name in the header, default priority on Create Task	All signed-in users	All signed-in users	– (signed in only)	Org

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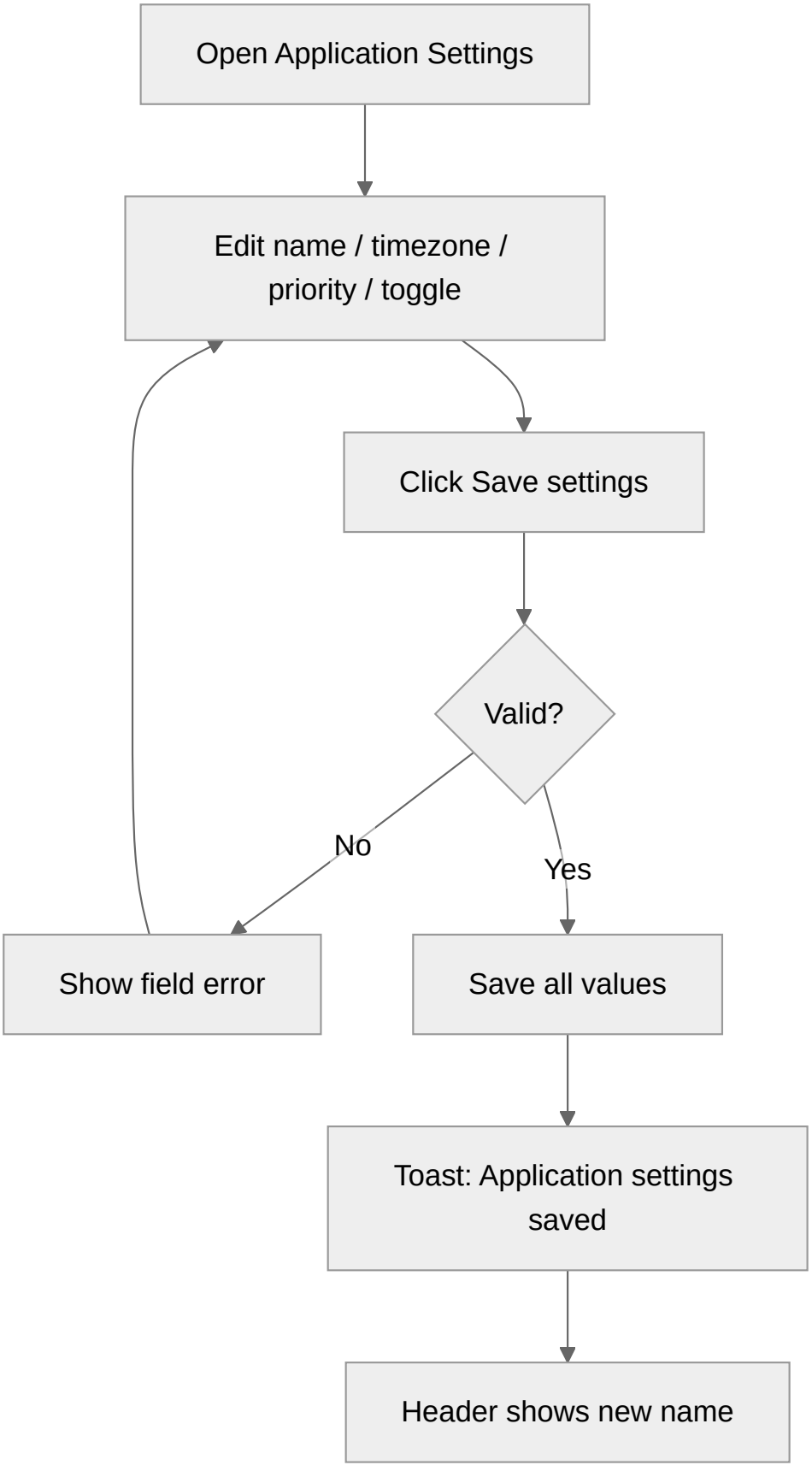
#	Functionality	Purpose	Who Can See	Who Can Use	Permission Required	Scope
3	Change application name	Rename the product shown in the sidebar and header	Administrator	Administrator	`settings.application.manage`	Org
4	Change default timezone	Set the single timezone used for deadline days and reminders	Administrator	Administrator	`settings.application.manage`	Org
5	Change default task priority	Pre-select a priority on Create Task	Administrator	Administrator	`settings.application.manage`	Org
6	Turn in-app notifications on or off	Stop or resume creating new bell notifications	Administrator	Administrator	`settings.application.manage`	Org

5.3 Step-by-Step Workflow – Save Application Settings

1. User opens **Settings → Application Settings**.
2. System loads and shows the current values. If loading fails, it shows *"Could not load the application settings."* (or the server's message) with a **Retry** button.
3. User changes the application name, timezone, default priority and/or the in-app notifications toggle.
4. User clicks **Save settings**.
5. The screen checks the fields first. A blank or over-long name shows *"Application name is required and must be 100 characters or fewer."* A blank timezone shows *"Timezone is required."*
6. The server checks the data again. An unknown timezone id is refused with *"Unknown timezone."*
7. System saves all four values, then shows the toast *"Application settings saved"* and a **Saved** tick.
8. The new brand name appears in the sidebar and header at once, without reloading the page. The new timezone applies to reminders and deadline checks at once, with no restart.

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Flow Diagram



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5.4 Business Rules & Validations

- Application name is required and can be at most 100 characters. Spaces before and after it are removed.
- Timezone is required and must be an id the server recognises (for example `Asia/Kolkata` or `UTC`).
- Default priority must be one of Low, Medium, High or Critical.
- Every field must be sent. A save that leaves a field out is refused; the system does not quietly use a default.
- If a stored value is missing or cannot be read, the system falls back to a default: name "TaskFlow", priority Medium, in-app notifications on, and the timezone from the server configuration (or UTC).
- If the stored timezone is not recognised when reminders run, the system logs the problem and uses UTC, so reminders never stop.
- Turning in-app notifications off stops new bell notifications for every event. Existing notifications are kept.
- Reminder intervals and Mail delivery are **not** changed here. They belong to Reminder Settings.

5.5 Messages Shown to the User

Situation	Message
Success	Application settings saved
Name blank or too long (screen)	Application name is required and must be 100 characters or fewer.
Name blank (server)	Application name cannot be blank.
Timezone blank (screen)	Timezone is required.
Timezone blank (server)	Timezone cannot be blank.
Timezone not recognised	Unknown timezone.
Load failed	Could not load the application settings.
Save failed	Could not save the application settings.
No permission	The menu item is hidden, and opening the address returns the user to their dashboard. A direct save attempt is refused (HTTP 403).

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6. Permission Summary

Permission Key	Description	Administrator	Manager	Employee	Custom Role
`settings.application.manage`	Change application-wide settings	Granted	Denied	Denied	Configurable
– (signed in)	Read application settings (brand name, default priority)	Always On	Always On	Always On	Always On

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> Manager and Employee values are the defaults given when the permission is first created. The Administrator role is given every permission again each time the application starts.

7. Related Modules

- **08.2 Reminder Settings** – Holds the reminder intervals and Mail delivery; this screen only links to it. Reminder Settings shows the application timezone read-only.
- **Monitoring (Task Management)** – Create Task pre-selects the default priority from this screen.
- **Communication (Notifications)** – The in-app notifications switch decides whether bell notifications are created at all. The reminder engine uses the application timezone.
- **Dashboard and Reports** – Use the application timezone to decide which tasks are due today or overdue.
- **TaskFlow Assistant (TFA)** – Uses the application name as the brand name.

8. Expected Outcome

An Administrator can maintain the application name, timezone, default priority and in-app notifications from the screen. Every user sees the new brand name at once, and every deadline calculation uses the one application timezone without a restart.

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